

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, warmer, sunshine through high clouds, high 80. **Tonight**, clear to partly cloudy, low 66. **Tomorrow**, warm, partly cloudy, a light breeze, high 84. Weather map, Page A20.

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TUESDAY, MAY 26, 2026

Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00



WAYAN BARRE FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Lessons From ‘Model’ for Climate Migration
The residents of a Louisiana isle found safety after moving to higher ground. But some say others should think twice. Page A10.

Pope, in Encyclical, Offers a Map for Navigating the Perils of A.I.

This article is by **Motoko Rich, Elisabetta Povoledo and Elizabeth Dias.**

Pope Leo XIV on Monday set out a sweeping vision for corporate executives, politicians and individuals who will shape and be shaped by the future of artificial intelligence, warning leaders to safeguard humanity from A.I.’s most disruptive effects.

Leo’s declaration came in the form of a papal encyclical, an open letter to “all people of good will” that ran to roughly 42,300 words in its English version. It outlined his desire to protect human dignity and agency in an age in which

technology threatens to replace humans in many professional and social roles. He presented it alongside Christopher Olah, a founder of Anthropic, a major A.I. developer, in a symbolic gesture of dialogue between leaders of the spiritual and technological worlds. While emphasizing that “technology should not be considered, in itself, as a force antagonistic to humanity,” he wrote that “the pursuit of greater profits cannot justify choices that systematically sacrifice jobs.”

Among other things, Leo called for government regulation of the private companies that are driving the development of A.I.; protection and retraining for workers

Calling for Regulations and the Protection of Human Dignity

whose jobs are threatened; education to help students think critically about the technology; action to protect children from violent, hypersexualized or fake information online that is often generated by A.I.; and safeguards to ensure that humans, not artificial intelligence, remain responsible for all decisions regarding the use of weapons.

Above all, he emphasized the importance of retaining a fundamental social role for all humans. “A society that guarantees employment to only a small fraction of the population, despite having a high level of technical development, risks exposing many to forced inactivity,” he wrote.

“This creates a paradox of material progress and anthropological regression that undermines

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LEO VS. MOGULS The pope wants to take A.I. down a notch. Can he change tech firms, or will tech take over the papacy? PAGE B1

In City at Heart of Ebola Outbreak, ‘the Virus Is Far Ahead of Us’

By **DECLAN WALSH**

BUNIA, Democratic Republic of Congo — Since an Ebola outbreak was declared in Bunia, a bustling city in northeastern Democratic Republic of Congo, global alarms have gone off. Borders have slammed shut, flights have been diverted as far as the United States and the Congolese World Cup team is currently in quarantine in Belgium.

Yet here in Bunia, at the heart of the crisis, the usual signs of an organized response — large medical tents, medics in sealed white suits and goggles and patients lying in strict isolation — are not yet in place.

Instead, the incipient aid effort is only getting set up. Outside Bunia’s main hospital on Saturday, workers hammered nails and pushed up tents a few yards from the main door, in a frantic scramble to erect a handful of isolation wards where patients can be triaged, isolated and treated.

“The virus is far ahead of us,” said Ahmed Mahat, a manager with International Medical Corps, which is building two of the isolation wards. “And it’s spreading fast.”

The world is playing catch-up in Congo. Caught flat-footed by an outbreak that was discovered disastrously late — perhaps two months after it started — the system of international response is struggling onto its feet.

Almost nothing was in place when the first patient was confirmed with the rare Bundibugyo species of the virus on May 15. Shortly after, Macky Mbavugha, a field manager with the Interna-



ARLETTE BASHIZI FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Disinfecting a market in Bunia. A lab in the Congo city processes only about 40 Ebola tests a day.

tional Rescue Committee, contacted the local health office to see if it had stocks of protective equipment. He found empty shelves.

“Zero,” he said. “Everyone was totally unprepared.”

President Trump’s aid cuts exacerbated the crisis, he added. If American funding for Congo had not been slashed last year, “maybe the alert would have sounded earlier,” Mr. Mbavugha said, echoing a widely held assessment in the aid community.

And when larger aid groups

sought out local organizations to bolster the Ebola response, many were gone, having closed after funding dried up last year, he said.

Not only was the virus a rare species — with no cure or vaccine, and few tests for it available in the field — it enjoyed a spectacular head start over the aid workers who were trying to contain it. Only a week ago, the World Health Organization estimated that 246 people had contracted the virus, mostly in the area around Bunia and a nearby district.

On Monday, the W.H.O. reported that there were at least 900 suspected cases and 220 suspected deaths — an acceleration at such an early stage of an outbreak that experts said was terrifying. Less than two weeks since the Ebola outbreak was declared, it was already the third largest on record.

Even now, just about everything is in short supply. Congolese health workers treating patients or burying the dead lack basic pro-

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Strait Deal Is One Hurdle, Starting Traffic Is Another

Risks From Collisions, Shallow Water and Mines for Fleet of Stranded Ships

By **JENNY GROSS**

LONDON — When the Strait of Hormuz finally reopens, shipping companies will need to know which oil tankers get to start moving first, and whom to ask for the go-ahead. Vessels will need guidance on routes. And there’s the question of the potential threat of mines in the strait.

The United States and Iran are moving closer to securing a deal to reopen the strait, and captains aboard the roughly 1,500 ships that have been stranded in the Persian Gulf for nearly three months are getting ready.

But a lot has to happen before they can start moving through the narrow and vital waterway, which carried one-fifth of the world’s oil and gas before the war with Iran.

Even if a final deal is reached, the prewar status quo, when upward of 130 ships transited the strait each day, will be perhaps weeks or even months away. That is also one reason that energy prices, which have climbed in the United States and around the world, are not expected to fall fast.

Before ships can begin leaving the strait, which is 21 nautical miles wide at its narrowest, companies will need to know how their ships will be prioritized, said Jakob P. Larsen, the chief safety and security officer of the Baltic and International Maritime Council, which represents maritime companies. Ideally, he added, vessels would be asked to follow a speed limit to minimize the risk of colliding or grounding in shallow water.

“We will need to know which route to take and then, of course, what kind of coordination or permits or whatever would need to be obtained with which authorities,” Mr. Larsen said.

The potential for ships to strike sea mines that Iran is believed to have planted in the strait is a peril. British military officials have said

Iran’s mines include ones that sit on the seabed and send gas bubbles to the surface, causing serious damage to a ship’s hull.

Navies including those of the United States, Britain, France and Germany would need several weeks to deploy minesweepers, the International Energy Agency said in a report this month. This risk is likely to keep maritime insurance rates high.

Iran has threatened to exercise control of the strait and recently established a regulatory agency to run operations there.



REUTERS

Companies will need to know how their ships will be prioritized if passage through the Strait of Hormuz is restored.

Ships that have been maintained by skeleton crews of seafarers — about 20,000 in all — have to be restarted.

Drifting in the warm waters of the Persian Gulf, vessels have accumulated barnacles, sea creatures and algae that can impede navigation.

Hapag-Lloyd, the fifth-largest container shipping group in the world, has been able to get one vessel out since the lockdown began. That ship required a lot of cleaning, Rolf Habben Jansen, the

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G.O.P. Worries It’s Trump First, Midterms Last

By **SHANE GOLDMACHER and PATRICIA MAZZEI**

A little more than five months ahead of the midterm elections, President Trump seems to be focused on virtually anything other than keeping Republican control of Congress.

He endorsed a MAGA challenger over Texas’ senior Republican senator, ignoring warnings that he could endanger the seat. He has boasted almost daily about his expensive and expansive new White House ballroom. He has minimized rising gas costs, waving off spiking prices at the pump as “peanuts” last week compared with what he is pursuing in Iran. And even as he engaged over the weekend in negotiations to end the Iran war that he began, Mr. Trump has made plain that he prioritizes his record abroad above domestic affordability, which he has dismissed repeatedly as a Democratic “hoax.”

For many, a new jaw-dropper came last week when Mr. Trump created a \$1.8 billion fund to pay people who say they have been victims of “weaponization and lawfare,” including those who attacked the Capitol and law enforcement officers there, on Jan. 6, 2021.

Incensed Senate Republicans, many of whom lived through that day, returned home vexed by a president who appears set on pursuing his personal priorities

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In New World, Gore Rethinks How to Save It

By **CHICO HARLAN**

It was the world’s most famous movie built around a slide show: Al Gore, in a darkened auditorium, clicking through images that warned of a heating planet. Within the film’s first minutes, Mr. Gore described a “moral imperative to make big changes,” a call he echoed several times onstage.

Twenty years after the release of “An Inconvenient Truth,” his Oscar-winning documentary, it is remembered mostly for its cultural resonance — for bringing awareness of global warming into the mainstream. Mr. Gore and his intense focus on climate change energized both supporters on the left and critics on the right. In a self-effacing bit on “Saturday Night Live,” Mr. Gore warned viewers about glaciers on the attack. A year later, he shared the Nobel Peace Prize.

As the years passed, Mr. Gore has kept going with his slide show, giving presentations in hundreds of cities worldwide, most recently in Nashville this month.

And with time, the slide show has changed in ways that reflect how the conversation about climate change has shifted over the course of a generation.

Onstage in Nashville, Mr. Gore made a central argument that would have been inconceivable two decades ago. Rather than directly invoking morality, he led with economics.

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A Reef Repair Job

In a devastated section of the Pacific Ocean, a conservation group is trying to offset the loss of coral. PAGE A7

Rethinking Ukraine’s Past

A divisive World War II figure was given state honors for his reburial, signaling a shift in politics. PAGE A5

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A.I. Floods Judges’ Dockets

For years, courts have welcomed cases brought by self-represented litigants. Now those with A.I. access are consuming more and more bandwidth. PAGE A14

Explosion Threat Is Reduced

Evacuation orders remain for residents around Garden Grove, Calif., the site of an unstable vat of chemicals. PAGE A16

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A Wembyologist’s Findings

A reporter who has covered the Spurs star Victor Wembanyama all season shared what he learned. PAGE B7



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Time-Traveling on Route 66

We drove a long stretch of the Mother Road to take its pulse and size up the next automotive century. PAGE B6

Seed Oils Losing Favor

Businesses are finding different (and pricier) ways to fry foods as shoppers demand healthier alternatives. PAGE B1

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When the Canary Flew Away

In the final stages of his dementia, a man’s long-lost memory from childhood returned, perfectly formed. What was going on in his brain? PAGE D1

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Transformer of How We Eat

Carlo Petrini, through his Slow Food organization, spurred a worldwide shift toward sustainability and thoughtful cuisine. He was 76. PAGE B12

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Jessica Brandt

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He’s Trolling Your Trash

Fans seek out Thomas Dambo’s trolls, made out of scrap, in off-the-beaten-track spots. But the art world’s approval has been elusive, until now. PAGE C1

